

THE LOST JAMAICAN · FREE SUBSCRIBER PACK

The Starter Prompt Pack

Ten prompts you can paste straight into your own model tonight — the research, scripting, casting, shot and quality-control prompts we actually run, written so they work on any capable text or image model.

Fill in the **[bracketed]** parts. Everything else is the prompt.

Part one — Research and story

1. Find the governing contradiction

You are a documentary researcher. My subject is [NAME], [ONE-LINE WHO THEY ARE].

Give me five candidate "governing contradictions" for a short documentary: the gap between who the public believed this person was and what was actually happening.

For each candidate give me:

- the contradiction in one sentence, in the form "Everyone knew X. What nobody knew was Y."
- why it is surprising to someone who already knows the subject
- what evidence would have to exist for it to be true
- how strong you judge the sourcing to be, and what is still unverified

Rank them by how much a viewer would want to know the answer. Do not invent specifics. Where you are unsure, say so plainly.

Why it works: it forces a claim with a shape, and forces the model to separate what it knows from what it is guessing.

2. Build the four ledgers

Research [NAME] and return four separate lists. Do not blend them.

FACTS - only items where at least two independent publishers agree. Include dates and who reported it.

CLAIMS - widely repeated but traceable to a single source. Mark each with the source it traces back to.

HIDDEN GEMS - true, verifiable details that almost nobody repeats. These should make a knowledgeable fan sit up.

REJECTED - things you found that I should NOT say, each with the reason.

If a list would be empty, say it is empty rather than padding it.

The rejected list is the point. It stops a rumour quietly reappearing later in the build.

3. The cold open

Write three cold opens for a short documentary about [NAME].

Rules:

- Open on a body mid-action, never on a date and never on a name.
- State the consequence first, then rewind.
- Name an expectation the audience holds, then break it.
- No narrator throat-clearing. First word is already the story.
- Eight seconds maximum, spoken at roughly 3.3 words per second.

Give me the word count and the spoken duration for each.

Part two — Script

4. Beat the script to the clock

Here is my script: [PASTE SCRIPT]

Break it into beats. A beat is one complete turn of thought.

For each beat return: the text, the word count, the spoken duration at 3.3 words per second, and a flag if it runs longer than 3.5 seconds.

Then rewrite every flagged beat so it lands under 3.5 seconds without losing the information. Show me the before and after side by side.

Retention dies in long beats. This is the single highest-value edit pass in the whole system.

5. Every noun is a visual

Here is my script: [PASTE SCRIPT]

List every concrete noun that is spoken: every named person, place, object and organisation.

For each one tell me:

- the exact moment it is spoken
- whether it can plausibly be shown on screen at that moment
- if it can, a one-line description of the shot
- if it cannot be shown, say so and propose a rewrite that removes the noun

I want no spoken noun left without something on screen.

Part three — Casting and shots

6. The character card

Write a reusable character card for [NAME] in [ERA / YEAR], for image generation.

Include, in plain descriptive language:

- face shape, bone structure, eyes, nose, mouth, distinguishing marks
- exact skin tone, described honestly and specifically
- hair length, texture and how it is worn in this era
- facial hair, described strand by strand if present
- build and posture
- era-accurate wardrobe

Rules:

- Describe only what a photograph would show. No adjectives about personality.
- Never lighten or flatten the skin tone.
- Do not mention any brand, logo or text on clothing.
- Write it as one flowing paragraph I can paste in front of any scene description.

7. Beats to shot list

Here are my beats: [PASTE BEATS]

Turn them into a shot list. Use one shot per one to three beats.

For each shot give me:

- which beats it covers
- shot size (wide, medium, or detail)
- what the hero is physically doing - he must literally perform the narrated action
- camera angle, and make sure adjacent shots differ
- anyone else in frame and the verb they are performing

Hard rules: the hero never looks at the camera. No person appears without an action. If a shot has no person, describe the space positively rather than listing what is absent.

8. Scene prompt from a shot

Turn this shot into an image prompt: [PASTE ONE SHOT]

Structure it as: [CHARACTER CARD] + [what he is doing] + [where he is] + [light and time of day] + [lens and framing] + [film look].

Rules:

- Positive description only. Never write "no crowd" or "nobody in the background" - prohibitions summon what they forbid. Describe the emptiness instead.

- Wide or medium only if likeness matters in this shot.
- Name the light source explicitly.
- Do not request any on-screen text.

The trap this avoids: "an empty street, no people" reliably generates people. "A bare street at dawn, shutters down, one stray dog" does not.

Part four — Quality control

9. Catch the fabrications

Here is my finished script: [PASTE SCRIPT]

Act as a hostile fact-checker who wants this taken down.

List every factual assertion. For each one:

- classify it as verifiable, disputed, or unsupported
- say what a critic would demand as proof
- flag anything stated as fact that is actually one source repeated

Then list every sentence that implies something defamatory about a real, living person, and rewrite it to state only what is documented.

Run this before you render anything. Fixing a fabricated claim after fifty shots are rendered costs a whole day.

10. The pre-publish gate

I am about to publish. Check this against the list and answer PASS or FAIL for each, with the reason:

1. Is every spoken name visible on screen while it is spoken?
2. Does any shot contain a person who is not in the script?
3. Does the hero look at the camera at any point?
4. Is the opening eight seconds free of dates and free of narrator throat-clearing?
5. Does any beat run longer than 3.5 seconds?
6. Is the thumbnail readable at thumbnail size, with the name inside the safe zone?
7. Is the call to action a real instruction rather than a label?
8. Is there any claim in the script that the research ledger marked as rejected?

Script: [PASTE] Shot list: [PASTE]